

STAGE TEN • RELATIONSHIPS & CONNECTIONS

FIRSTS

COMPLETION CRITERIA

What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Ten credential

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

Stage Ten • Relationships & Connections

PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Ten, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. Unlike a stage such as Two, where a facilitator can directly spot-check an externally visible artifact (a LinkedIn profile), this stage's real actions are private, personal relationships — completion here relies more on honest self-report than direct verification, and that difference is built into the standard itself.

Per-FIRST Standard

STANDARD

A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet has a genuine, specific answer in every required field, and for FIRSTS involving a real external action (N5's appreciation note, N22's mentor meeting request, N29's peer recommendation), when that action has genuinely been taken, not just planned.

Stage-Level Completion Checklist

- All 30 Templates worksheets completed with genuine, specific answers (see per-FIRST standard above).
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 3 sessions.
- At least one real, external relationship-building action confirmed by self-report: an appreciation note actually sent, a mentor meeting actually requested, or a real conversation actually had.
- A genuine, honest full-stage reflection completed for FIRST N30, covering all three sections, not just the most recent one.

Facilitator Sign-Off

The facilitator reviews each participant's completed Templates workbook and confirms, through brief self-report rather than direct verification (these are private, real relationships that a facilitator generally cannot or should not verify independently), that at least one real external action was genuinely taken during this stage. Spot-check for genuine specificity in written reflections, not just completion.

Credential Trigger

HOW THE BADGE WORKS

Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked "Stage Ten Complete" in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Ten digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.